

**Notes: Brogaard, Engelberg & Parsons (JFE, 2014)**  
**Networks and productivity: Causal evidence from editor rotations**

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# 1 Big picture

- **Question.** Do professional networks improve the allocation of scarce journal slots, or do they lead to favoritism?
- **Setting.** The paper studies 30 leading economics and finance journals and over 50,000 articles.
- **Treatment.** A school is connected to a journal-year when the journal editor two years earlier was affiliated with that school.
- **Output result.** During an editor’s tenure, current university colleagues publish roughly twice as many papers in the editor’s journal.
- **Quality result.** Connected articles have higher ex post citation counts, even excluding same-journal and self-citations.
- **Economic takeaway.** Networks can create conflicts, but they can also transmit useful private information. In this setting the information channel appears to dominate simple nepotism.

# 2 Incremental contribution

- The paper moves beyond showing that networks benefit connected agents; it asks whether connected outcomes are allocatively efficient.
- Editor rotations provide sharp quasi-experimental timing variation in network connections.
- The design combines school-year, journal-year, and school-journal fixed effects with false-match timing tests.
- The paper evaluates both output and ex post quality through citations, making it possible to distinguish favoritism from informed selection.
- The model explains why connected articles can be riskier ex ante but better selected ex post.

# 3 Data and measurement

The data combine journal histories, editor affiliations, author affiliations, coauthor networks, Web of Science article data, and citation counts. The unit of observation in publication-count regressions is a school–journal–year triple. The main connection variables are colleague connection, coauthor connection, and any connection.

**Interpretation.** Citations proxy for ex post article quality; placement variables proxy for editorial assessment of likely importance.

# 4 Models and empirical specifications

## 4.1 Publication-count regression

$$PublishedArticles_{i,j,t} = \beta DuringEditorship_{i,j,t} + FE + \varepsilon_{i,j,t}.$$

**Interpretation.**  $\beta$  measures the change in school  $i$ ’s publications in journal  $j$  during a connected editor’s tenure.

## 4.2 False-match regression

$$PublishedArticles_{i,j,t} = \beta_D During_{i,j,t} + \beta_B JustBefore_{i,j,t} + \beta_A JustAfter_{i,j,t} + FE + \varepsilon_{i,j,t}.$$

**Interpretation.** The placebo windows test whether productivity is already high before the editor arrives or remains high after the editor leaves.

## 4.3 Citation-quality regression

$$\log(Citations_{k,j,t}) = \beta ConnectedArticle_{k,j,t} + \gamma PastCites_k + \delta NumAuthors_k + FE + \varepsilon_{k,j,t}.$$

**Interpretation.** If connected papers were low-quality favoritism,  $\beta$  should be negative. The paper finds the opposite.

## 4.4 Network-information model

$$s_{E,i}|(q_{E,i} = Q) = \begin{cases} high & \text{with probability } x, \\ low & \text{with probability } 1 - x, \end{cases} \quad x \geq \frac{1}{2}.$$

**Interpretation.** Connected editors can have more informative signals about high-upside papers, allowing them to select the good connected papers and reject the duds.

# 5 Identification and empirical design

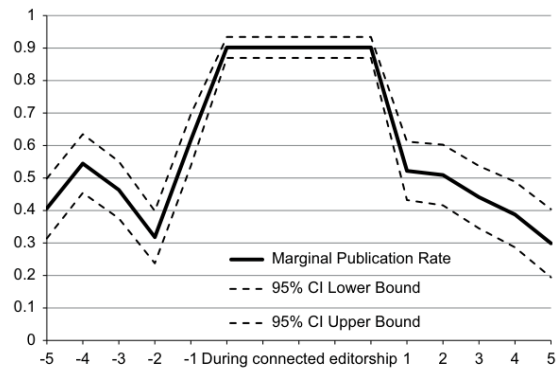
The identifying variation comes from editor rotations. Journal-year effects absorb journal size and field shocks. School-year effects absorb time-varying university productivity. School-journal effects absorb persistent specialization between schools and journals. False editorships test for gradual pre- and post-trends. Citation regressions test whether the additional accepted papers are lower or higher quality.

# 6 Tables and figures

## 6.1 Figure 1: Marginal publication rates before, during, and after connected editor's tenure + Table 1: Journals

**Read:** Figure 1 shows a sharp increase during connected editorship and a decline after departure. Table 1 lists the 30 journals and the starting years used in the sample.

**Economic message.** Broad journal coverage plus sharp timing provides the core identification.



uring, and after connected editor's tenure. The figure plots coefficients from

(a) Figure 1: marginal publication rates

**Table 1**

The table lists 30 major economics journals for which we have detailed editorial histories. House journal is "Yes" if every year of the editorial history contains at least one editor from the same university (e.g., Harvard and the *Quarterly Journal of Economics*). First year in sample is the first year the journal's publications have full records in the Web of Science database.

|    | Journal                                   | House journal? | First year in sample |
|----|-------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------|
| 1  | ECONOMETRICA                              | No             | 1955                 |
| 2  | JOURNAL OF ECONOMIC LITERATURE            | No             | 1969                 |
| 3  | JOURNAL OF POLITICAL ECONOMY              | Yes            | 1956                 |
| 4  | JOURNAL OF FINANCIAL ECONOMICS            | Yes            | 1976                 |
| 5  | QUARTERLY JOURNAL OF ECONOMICS            | Yes            | 1956                 |
| 6  | AMERICAN ECONOMIC REVIEW                  | No             | 1956                 |
| 7  | JOURNAL OF ECONOMIC PERSPECTIVES          | No             | 1988                 |
| 8  | JOURNAL OF FINANCE                        | No             | 1956                 |
| 9  | JOURNAL OF LAW & ECONOMICS                | Yes            | 1958                 |
| 10 | REVIEW OF ECONOMIC STUDIES                | No             | 1956                 |
| 11 | RAND JOURNAL OF ECONOMICS                 | No             | 1984                 |
| 12 | JOURNAL OF MONETARY ECONOMICS             | Yes            | 1976                 |
| 13 | REVIEW OF FINANCIAL STUDIES               | No             | 1990                 |
| 14 | JOURNAL OF ECONOMETRICS                   | No             | 1980                 |
| 15 | JOURNAL OF LABOR ECONOMICS                | Yes            | 1983                 |
| 16 | JOURNAL OF ECONOMIC GROWTH                | Yes            | 1999                 |
| 17 | REVIEW OF ECONOMICS & STATISTICS          | Yes            | 1956                 |
| 18 | JOURNAL OF ECONOMIC THEORY                | No             | 1969                 |
| 19 | JOURNAL OF BUSINESS & ECONOMIC STATISTICS | No             | 1985                 |
| 20 | ECONOMIC JOURNAL                          | No             | 1956                 |
| 21 | JOURNAL OF HUMAN RESOURCES                | Yes            | 1966                 |
| 22 | JOURNAL OF INTERNATIONAL ECONOMICS        | No             | 1971                 |
| 23 | JOURNAL OF PUBLIC ECONOMICS               | No             | 1976                 |
| 24 | INTERNATIONAL ECONOMIC REVIEW             | Yes            | 1960                 |
| 25 | JOURNAL OF APPLIED ECONOMETRICS           | Yes            | 1987                 |
| 26 | JOURNAL OF INDUSTRIAL ECONOMICS           | No             | 1956                 |
| 27 | JOURNAL OF MONEY CREDIT & BANKING         | Yes            | 1976                 |
| 28 | GAMES & ECONOMIC BEHAVIOR                 | Yes            | 1991                 |
| 29 | ECONOMIC THEORY                           | No             | 1995                 |
| 30 | REVIEW OF ECONOMIC DYNAMICS               | No             | 2001                 |

(b) Table 1: journals

## 6.2 Table 2: Summary statistics

**Read:** The average journal publishes 47.38 articles per year; 7.1% of articles are colleague-connected and 8.8% are any-connected. Connected articles have higher raw citations than unconnected articles.

**Economic message.** The raw data already suggest that connected publications are not simply low-quality favoritism.

**Table 2**

Summary statistics.

Articles per journal year is the number of articles a journal publishes in a given year. Number of editors per journal year is the number of editors a journal has in a given year. Editor tenure is the number of years an editor serves at a journal. Number of editor coauthors is the number of historical coauthors an editor has while serving as editor. Number of authors per article is the number of authors of a given article. Times Cited Count is the Web of Science count of the number of times an article has been cited in the Web of Science database. Same-journal citations is the number of times a given article has been cited by a publication in the same journal. Self-citations is the number of times a given article has been cited by a publication with the same author(s). Colleague-connected article is a dummy variable which takes the value one if the article has an author at the same institution as the journal's editor. Coauthor-connected article is a dummy variable which takes the value one if the article has an author which is a prior coauthor of the editor. Any-connected article is the maximum of Colleague-connected article and Coauthor-connected article.

|                                         | Mean  | Standard deviation | 5th Percentile | 25th Percentile | Median | 75th Percentile | 95th Percentile |
|-----------------------------------------|-------|--------------------|----------------|-----------------|--------|-----------------|-----------------|
| Articles per journal year               | 47.38 | 26.41              | 11             | 29              | 43     | 59              | 96              |
| Number of editors per journal year      | 3.42  | 2.37               | 1              | 1               | 3      | 5               | 8               |
| Editor tenure (years)                   | 6.13  | 5.18               | 1              | 3               | 5      | 7               | 16              |
| Number of editor coauthors              | 12.60 | 10.37              | 1              | 5               | 10     | 17              | 34              |
| Number of authors per article           | 1.66  | 0.78               | 1              | 1               | 2      | 2               | 3               |
| Colleague-connected article (dummy)     | 0.071 | 0.257              | 0              | 0               | 0      | 0               | 1               |
| Coauthor-connected article (dummy)      | 0.032 | 0.176              | 0              | 0               | 0      | 0               | 0               |
| Any-connected article (dummy)           | 0.088 | 0.283              | 0              | 0               | 0      | 0               | 1               |
| Times cited count                       | 32.95 | 105.47             | 0              | 3               | 10     | 30              | 125             |
| Times cited count: Connected articles   | 51.55 | 164.81             | 0              | 4               | 15     | 45              | 190             |
| Times cited count: Unconnected articles | 31.15 | 97.68              | 0              | 3               | 10     | 29              | 119             |
| Times cited count (top 50 schools)      | 44.50 | 127.60             | 0              | 4               | 15     | 43              | 167             |
| Same-journal citations                  | 1.84  | 4.63               | 0              | 0               | 0      | 2               | 8               |
| Self-citations                          | 1.07  | 2.04               | 0              | 0               | 0      | 1               | 5               |
| Top 30 journal citations                | 9.11  | 24.19              | 0              | 0               | 2      | 9               | 38              |

**Table 3**

Editor-author connectivity and publication rates.

Each observation is a school, journal, year triplet  $(i, j, t)$  that counts the number of publications school  $i$  has in journal  $j$  in year  $t$ . The top panel considers the 146 schools that, at any point, have had one or more editors at the 30 journals in Table 1. During editorship is a dummy variable that takes the value of one if school  $i$  has an editor at journal  $j$  in year  $t$ . Panel B considers the three finance journals (*Journal of Finance*, *Journal of Financial Economics*, and *Review of Financial Studies*) and Panel C considers the top economics journals (*AER*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Econometrica*, *QJE*, and *Review of Economic Studies*). Robust standard errors clustered by school are in parentheses. \*, \*\*, \*\*\* represent significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

Panel A: All journals

Dependent variable: Published articles

|                              |                     |                     |                     |                     |
|------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| During editorship            | 1.421***<br>(0.156) | 1.427***<br>(0.154) | 0.333***<br>(0.054) | 0.297***<br>(0.050) |
| Journal*Year fixed effects   | No                  | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Journal*School fixed effects | No                  | No                  | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| School*Year fixed effects    | No                  | No                  | No                  | Yes                 |
| Observations                 | 163,520             | 163,520             | 163,520             | 163,520             |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.0376              | 0.1014              | 0.5053              | 0.5246              |

Panel B: Finance journals

Dependent variable: Published articles

|                              |                     |                     |                     |                     |
|------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| During editorship            | 1.178***<br>(0.205) | 1.349***<br>(0.181) | 0.636***<br>(0.154) | 0.609***<br>(0.138) |
| Journal*Year fixed effects   | No                  | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Journal*School fixed effects | No                  | No                  | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| School*Year fixed effects    | No                  | No                  | No                  | Yes                 |
| Observations                 | 3,888               | 3,888               | 3,888               | 3,888               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.0224              | 0.1083              | 0.4687              | 0.5084              |

Panel C: Top economics journals

Dependent variable: Published articles

|                              |                      |                      |                     |                   |
|------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|---------------------|-------------------|
| During editorship            | 2.433***<br>(0.5610) | 2.353***<br>(0.5820) | 0.291**<br>(0.1370) | 0.183<br>(0.1250) |
| Journal*Year fixed effects   | No                   | Yes                  | Yes                 | Yes               |
| Journal*School fixed effects | No                   | No                   | Yes                 | Yes               |
| School*Year fixed effects    | No                   | No                   | No                  | Yes               |
| Observations                 | 11,350               | 11,350               | 11,350              | 11,350            |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>      | 0.0589               | 0.1371               | 0.6572              | 0.6869            |

## 6.3 Table 3: Editor-author connectivity and publication rates

**Read:** Connected editorship increases publication counts. The effect survives strong fixed effects, especially in the all-journal and finance-journal samples.

**Economic message.** Editors substantially increase publication opportunities for their current colleagues.

## 6.4 Table 4: False editor matches and publication probabilities

**Read:** The During coefficient is substantially larger than Just before and Just after coefficients.

**Economic message.** The effect is concentrated in the actual tenure window, making gradual productivity explanations less plausible.

## 6.5 Table 5: Editor-author connectivity and article quality

**Read:** Connected articles receive higher log citations in many specifications, and the effect is not negative after controls.

**Economic message.** This is the central evidence against inefficient nepotism.

## 6.6 Table 6: Article placement and citations

**Read:** Lead articles receive more citations; connected papers are more likely to be placed prominently.

**Economic message.** Placement evidence is consistent with editors having private information about connected papers' future impact.

## 6.7 Table 7: Citation influences by editors or authors

**Read:** The citation premium remains after excluding same-journal citations and self-citations.

Table 4

False editor matches and publication probabilities.

During editorship is a dummy variable which takes the value of one if school  $i$  has an editor at journal  $J$  in year  $t-2$ . Just Before (Just After) is a dummy variable that takes a value of one during the five years before (after) school  $i$  has an editor at journal  $J$ . The first column of each panel presents the results from an OLS model, the second column from a Poisson count model, and the third column from a negative binomial count model. Panel A considers all journals. Panel B considers the three finance journals (*Journal of Finance*, *Journal of Financial Economics*, and *Review of Financial Studies*) and Panel C considers the top economics journals (*AER*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Econometrica*, *QJE*, and *Review of Economic Studies*). \*, \*\*, and \*\*\* represent significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

| Panel A: All journals                  |                     |                     |                     |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| Dependent variable: Published articles |                     |                     |                     |
|                                        | OLS                 | Poisson             | Negative binomial   |
| During editorship                      | 0.902***<br>(0.040) | 0.850***<br>(0.016) | 0.963***<br>(0.039) |
| Just before                            | 0.473***<br>(0.039) | 0.570***<br>(0.022) | 0.599***<br>(0.049) |
| Just after                             | 0.442***<br>(0.045) | 0.501***<br>(0.025) | 0.717***<br>(0.055) |
| School fixed effects                   | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Year fixed effects                     | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Journal fixed effects                  | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Observations                           | 163,520             | 163,520             | 163,520             |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                | 0.2570              | -                   | -                   |
| Log likelihood                         | -                   | -98,609.4           | -94,426.8           |
| p-Value for test: During=Before        | < 0.001             | < 0.001             | < 0.001             |
| p-Value for test: During=After         | < 0.001             | < 0.001             | < 0.001             |
| p-Value for test: Before=After         | 0.616               | 0.050               | 0.027               |
| Panel B: Finance journals              |                     |                     |                     |
| Dependent variable: Published articles |                     |                     |                     |
|                                        | OLS                 | Poisson             | Negative binomial   |
| During editorship                      | 1.01***<br>(0.147)  | 0.568***<br>(0.051) | 0.647***<br>(0.070) |
| Just before                            | 0.269**<br>(0.140)  | 0.228***<br>(0.065) | 0.227***<br>(0.083) |
| Just after                             | 0.677***<br>(0.156) | 0.351***<br>(0.056) | 0.396***<br>(0.076) |
| School fixed effects                   | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Year fixed effects                     | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Journal fixed effects                  | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Observations                           | 3,888               | 3,888               | 3,888               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                | 0.3621              | -                   | -                   |
| Log likelihood                         | -                   | -5014.4             | -4883.2             |
| p-Value for test: During=Before        | < 0.001             | < 0.001             | < 0.001             |
| p-Value for test: During=After         | 0.108               | 0.013               | 0.008               |
| p-Value for test: Before=After         | 0.043               | 0.122               | 0.108               |
| Panel C: Top economics journals        |                     |                     |                     |
| Dependent variable: Published articles |                     |                     |                     |
|                                        | OLS                 | Poisson             | Negative binomial   |
| During editorship                      | 1.184***<br>(0.128) | 0.485***<br>(0.030) | 0.542***<br>(0.041) |
| Just before                            | 0.482***<br>(0.097) | 0.214***<br>(0.041) | 0.273***<br>(0.054) |
| Just after                             | 0.556***<br>(0.126) | 0.214***<br>(0.043) | 0.355***<br>(0.058) |
| School fixed effects                   | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Year fixed effects                     | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Journal fixed effects                  | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| Observations                           | 11,350              | 11,350              | 11,350              |

Table 5

Editor-author connectivity and article quality.

Times Cited Count: Last 5 Years is the sum total of an author's citations over the prior five years (for articles with multiple authors, the maximum is taken). Number of Authors is the number of authors of a given article. Colleague-connected article is a dummy variable which takes the value one if the article has at least one author at the same institution as the journal's editor. Coauthor-connected article is a dummy variable which takes the value one if the article has an author which is a prior coauthor of the editor. Any-connected article is the maximum of Colleague-connected article and Coauthor-connected article. Panel A considers all 30 journals in Table 1. Panel B considers the three finance journals (*Journal of Finance*, *Journal of Financial Economics*, and *Review of Financial Studies*) and Panel C considers the top economics journals (*AER*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Econometrica*, *QJE*, and *Review of Economic Studies*). Robust standard errors are in parentheses \*, \*\*, and \*\*\* represent significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

| Panel A: All journals                      |                     |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------|---------------------|
| Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |                     |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Coauthor-connected article                 | 0.350***<br>(0.044) |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Colleague-connected article                |                     | 0.425***<br>(0.029) |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Any-connected article                      |                     |                     | 0.405***<br>(0.026) | 0.250***<br>(0.019)  | 0.043**<br>(0.020)   | 0.089**<br>(0.036)  |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years            |                     |                     |                     | 0.114***<br>(0.003)  | 0.097***<br>(0.003)  | 0.040***<br>(0.011) |
| Number of authors                          |                     |                     |                     | -0.046***<br>(0.006) | -0.028***<br>(0.006) | 0.046***<br>(0.021) |
| Journal*Year fixed effects                 | No                  | No                  | No                  | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                 |
| School fixed effects                       | No                  | No                  | No                  | No                   | Yes                  | No                  |
| Author fixed effects                       | No                  | No                  | No                  | No                   | No                   | Yes                 |
| Observations                               | 54,046              | 54,046              | 54,046              | 54,046               | 49,218               | 8,908               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                    | 0.0013              | 0.0045              | 0.0052              | 0.3928               | 0.4157               | 0.6290              |
| Panel B: Finance journals                  |                     |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |                     |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Coauthor-connected article                 | 0.821***<br>(0.119) |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Colleague-connected article                |                     | 0.532***<br>(0.085) |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Any-connected article                      |                     |                     | 0.580***<br>(0.075) | 0.249***<br>(0.052)  | 0.079<br>(0.057)     | 0.190*<br>(0.103)   |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years            |                     |                     |                     | 0.111***<br>(0.007)  | 0.082***<br>(0.008)  | -0.003<br>(0.033)   |
| Number of authors                          |                     |                     |                     | -0.079***<br>(0.022) | -0.047**<br>(0.023)  | 0.018<br>(0.058)    |
| Journal*Year fixed effects                 | No                  | No                  | No                  | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                 |
| School fixed effects                       | No                  | No                  | No                  | No                   | No                   | No                  |
| Author fixed effects                       | No                  | No                  | No                  | No                   | No                   | Yes                 |
| Observations                               | 6,395               | 6,395               | 6,395               | 6,395                | 5,893                | 1,167               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                    | 0.0071              | 0.0064              | 0.0099              | 0.5373               | 0.5219               | 0.6548              |
| Panel C: Top economics journals            |                     |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |                     |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Coauthor-connected article                 | 0.617***<br>(0.086) |                     |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Colleague-connected article                |                     | 0.537***<br>(0.061) |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Any-connected article                      |                     |                     | 0.552***<br>(0.052) | 0.311***<br>(0.040)  | 0.036<br>(0.043)     | 0.029<br>(0.069)    |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years            |                     |                     |                     | 0.116***<br>(0.007)  | 0.093***<br>(0.007)  | -0.014<br>(0.020)   |
| Number of authors                          |                     |                     |                     | -0.049**<br>(0.022)  | -0.021<br>(0.023)    | 0.067<br>(0.043)    |

Table 4 (continued)

| Panel C: Top economics journals        |         |           |                   |
|----------------------------------------|---------|-----------|-------------------|
| Dependent variable: Published articles |         |           |                   |
|                                        | OLS     | Poisson   | Negative binomial |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                | 0.4668  | -         | -                 |
| Log likelihood                         | -       | -10,547.3 | -10,366.1         |
| p-Value for test: During=Before        | < 0.001 | < 0.001   | < 0.001           |
| p-Value for test: During=After         | < 0.001 | < 0.001   | 0.005             |
| p-Value for test: Before=After         | 0.653   | 0.171     | 0.327             |

Table 5 (continued)

| Panel C: Top economics journals            |        |        |        |        |        |        |
|--------------------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |        |        |        |        |        |        |
| Journal*Year fixed effects                 | No     | No     | No     | Yes    | Yes    | Yes    |
| School fixed effects                       | No     | No     | No     | No     | Yes    | No     |
| Author fixed effects                       | No     | No     | No     | No     | No     | Yes    |
| Observations                               | 15,871 | 15,871 | 15,871 | 15,871 | 13,311 | 2854   |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>                    | 0.0030 | 0.0055 | 0.0075 | 0.3149 | 0.3356 | 0.6297 |

**Table 6**  
Editor-author connectivity, article placement, and citations.  
*Times Cited Count: Last 5 Years* is the sum total of an author's citations over the prior five years (for articles with multiple authors, the maximum is taken). *Number of Authors* is the number of authors of a given article. *Colleague-connected article* is a dummy variable which takes the value one if the article has a coauthor at the same institution as the journal's editor. *Coauthor-connected article* is a dummy variable which takes the value one if the article has an author which is a prior coauthor of the editor. *Any-connected article* is the maximum of *Colleague-connected article* and *Coauthor-connected article*. *Lead article* is a dummy variable which takes the value one if an article is placed first in an issue. *Second article* and *Third article* are similarly defined. *Same issue as star article* is a dummy variable which takes the value one if a paper is in the same issue as the lead article with the most cite counts during the journal year. Robust standard errors are in parentheses. \*, \*\*, and \*\*\* represent significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

| Panel A: Placement and citations    |                                            |                      |                      |                                           |                     |                   |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------------|
|                                     | Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |                      |                      |                                           |                     |                   |
| Lead article                        | 0.530***<br>(0.018)                        |                      |                      |                                           |                     |                   |
| Second article                      |                                            | 0.263***<br>(0.018)  |                      |                                           |                     |                   |
| Third article                       |                                            |                      | 0.167***<br>(0.018)  |                                           |                     |                   |
| Same issue as star article          |                                            |                      |                      |                                           | 0.079***<br>(0.014) |                   |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years     | 0.113***<br>(0.003)                        | 0.117***<br>(0.003)  | 0.119***<br>(0.003)  | 0.116***<br>(0.003)                       |                     |                   |
| Number of authors                   | -0.042***<br>(0.009)                       | -0.040***<br>(0.009) | -0.048***<br>(0.009) | -0.042***<br>(0.010)                      |                     |                   |
| Journal*Year fixed effects          | Yes                                        | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                                       |                     |                   |
| Observations                        | 54,046                                     | 54,046               | 54,046               | 48,638                                    |                     |                   |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>             | 0.3883                                     | 0.3803               | 0.3788               | 0.3769                                    |                     |                   |
| Panel B: Connectivity and placement |                                            |                      |                      |                                           |                     |                   |
|                                     | Dependent variable: Lead article (dummy)   |                      |                      | Dependent variable: In star issue (dummy) |                     |                   |
| Coauthor-connected article          | 0.069***<br>(0.010)                        |                      |                      | 0.060***<br>(0.015)                       |                     |                   |
| Colleague-connected article         | 0.055***<br>(0.006)                        |                      |                      | 0.025***<br>(0.009)                       |                     |                   |
| Any-connected article               |                                            | 0.057***<br>(0.006)  | 0.055***<br>(0.006)  |                                           | 0.029***<br>(0.008) | 0.010<br>(0.007)  |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years     |                                            |                      | 0.009***<br>(0.001)  |                                           |                     | 0.0004<br>(0.001) |
| Number of authors                   |                                            |                      | -0.011***<br>(0.003) |                                           |                     | 0.002<br>(0.003)  |
| Journal*Year fixed effects          | No                                         | No                   | Yes                  | No                                        | No                  | Yes               |
| Observations                        | 54,046                                     | 54,046               | 54,046               | 48,638                                    | 48,638              | 48,638            |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>             | 0.0012                                     | 0.0020               | 0.0028               | 0.0112                                    | 0.0003              | 0.2286            |

**Table 7**  
Citation influences by editors or authors.  
*Times cited count: Last 5 years* is the sum total of an author's citations over the prior five years (for articles with multiple authors, the maximum is taken). *Number of Authors* is the number of authors of a given article. *Colleague-connected article* is a dummy variable which takes the value one if the article has a coauthor at the same institution as the journal's editor. *Coauthor-connected article* is a dummy variable which takes the value one if the article has an author which is a prior coauthor of the editor. *Any-connected article* is the maximum of *Colleague-connected article* and *Coauthor-connected article*. The first three columns exclude from *Times cited count* citations which come from the same journal (e.g., *QJE* articles citing *QJE* articles). The final three columns exclude from *Times cited count* citations which come from the same author(s). Panel A considers all 30 journals in Table 1. Panel B considers the three finance journals (*Journal of Finance*, *Journal of Financial Economics*, and *Review of Financial Studies*) and Panel C considers the top economics journals (*AER*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Econometrica*, *QJE*, and *Review of Economic Studies*). Robust standard errors are in parentheses. \*, \*\*, and \*\*\* represent significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

| Panel A: All journals           |                                            |                     |                     |                          |                      |                     |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|---------------------|
|                                 | Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |                     |                     |                          |                      |                     |
|                                 | Excluding same-journal citations           |                     |                     | Excluding self-citations |                      |                     |
| Any-connected article           | 0.227***<br>(0.018)                        | 0.033*<br>(0.019)   | 0.078**<br>(0.034)  | 0.243***<br>(0.018)      | 0.042**<br>(0.019)   | 0.086**<br>(0.034)  |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years | 0.106***<br>(0.003)                        | 0.090***<br>(0.003) | 0.030***<br>(0.011) | 0.106***<br>(0.003)      | 0.089***<br>(0.003)  | 0.042***<br>(0.011) |
| Number of authors               | -0.038***<br>(0.009)                       | -0.022**<br>(0.009) | 0.046***<br>(0.020) | -0.049***<br>(0.009)     | -0.032***<br>(0.009) | 0.034*<br>(0.020)   |
| Journal*Year fixed effects      | Yes                                        | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                      | Yes                  | Yes                 |
| School fixed effects            | No                                         | Yes                 | No                  | No                       | Yes                  | No                  |
| Author fixed effects            | No                                         | No                  | Yes                 | No                       | No                   | Yes                 |
| Observations                    | 53,864                                     | 49,077              | 8,891               | 53,861                   | 49,100               | 8,898               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>         | 0.3879                                     | 0.4119              | 0.5583              | 0.3833                   | 0.4088               | 0.5542              |
| Panel B: Finance journals       |                                            |                     |                     |                          |                      |                     |
|                                 | Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |                     |                     |                          |                      |                     |
|                                 | Excluding same-journal citations           |                     |                     | Excluding self-citations |                      |                     |
| Any-connected article           | 0.236***<br>(0.048)                        | 0.080<br>(0.053)    | 0.184*<br>(0.097)   | 0.244***<br>(0.049)      | 0.081<br>(0.054)     | 0.202**<br>(0.098)  |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years | 0.0100***<br>(0.007)                       | 0.075***<br>(0.008) | -0.001<br>(0.032)   | 0.0103***<br>(0.008)     | 0.077***<br>(0.008)  | -0.002<br>(0.032)   |
| Number of authors               | -0.066***<br>(0.021)                       | -0.039*<br>(0.021)  | 0.008<br>(0.055)    | -0.076***<br>(0.021)     | -0.049**<br>(0.021)  | 0.001<br>(0.055)    |
| Journal*Year fixed effects      | Yes                                        | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                      | Yes                  | Yes                 |
| School fixed effects            | No                                         | Yes                 | No                  | No                       | Yes                  | No                  |
| Author fixed effects            | No                                         | No                  | Yes                 | No                       | No                   | Yes                 |
| Observations                    | 6,381                                      | 5,879               | 1,165               | 6,393                    | 5,891                | 1,167               |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>         | 0.5396                                     | 0.5237              | 0.6409              | 0.5347                   | 0.5204               | 0.6420              |
| Panel C: Top economics journals |                                            |                     |                     |                          |                      |                     |
|                                 | Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |                     |                     |                          |                      |                     |
|                                 | Excluding same-journal citations           |                     |                     | Excluding self-citations |                      |                     |
| Any-connected article           | 0.307***<br>(0.034)                        | 0.054<br>(0.036)    | 0.100<br>(0.063)    | 0.304***<br>(0.035)      | 0.045<br>(0.037)     | 0.087<br>(0.066)    |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years | 0.110***<br>(0.007)                        | 0.088***<br>(0.007) | -0.018<br>(0.019)   | 0.110***<br>(0.007)      | 0.088***<br>(0.007)  | -0.013<br>(0.019)   |
| Number of authors               | -0.043**<br>(0.021)                        | -0.019<br>(0.022)   | 0.071*<br>(0.040)   | -0.055***<br>(0.021)     | -0.030<br>(0.022)    | 0.045<br>(0.042)    |
| Journal*Year fixed effects      | Yes                                        | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                      | Yes                  | Yes                 |
| School fixed effects            | No                                         | Yes                 | No                  | No                       | Yes                  | No                  |
| Author fixed effects            | No                                         | No                  | Yes                 | No                       | No                   | Yes                 |
| Observations                    | 15,779                                     | 13,253              | 2833                | 15,852                   | 13,297               | 2838                |
| Adjusted R <sup>2</sup>         | 0.322                                      | 0.344               | 0.6342              | 0.3116                   | 0.3358               | 0.6243              |

**Economic message.** The citation advantage is not mechanically produced by the editor, journal, or authors citing themselves.

## 6.8 Table 8: Productivity in other journals + model block

**Read:** Table 8 shows no increase in competing finance journals. The model block formalizes the editor's signal about exciting paper quality.

**Economic message.** The results support an information channel rather than broad productivity externalities.

**Table 8**

Productivity in other journals.

Each observation is a school, journal, year triplet  $(i, j, t)$  that counts the number of publications school  $i$  has in journal  $j$  in year  $t$ . *During JF editorship* is a dummy variable which takes the value of one for observation  $(i, j, t)$  if school  $i$  has an editor at the *Journal of Finance* (JF) in year  $t-2$ . *During JFE editorship* is a dummy variable which takes the value of one for observation  $(i, j, t)$  if school  $i$  has an editor at the *Journal of Financial Economics* (JFE) in year  $t-2$ . *During RFS editorship* is a dummy variable which takes the value of one for observation  $(i, j, t)$  if school  $i$  has an editor at the *Review of Financial Studies* (RFS) in year  $t-2$ . The first column only considers publications in the JFE and RFS, the second column only considers publications in the JF and RFS, and the third column only considers publications in the JF and JFE. \*, \*\*, and \*\*\* represent significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

| Finance journals                       |                              |                             |                             |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Dependent variable: Published articles |                              |                             |                             |
|                                        | Publications in<br>JFE & RFS | Publications in<br>JF & RFS | Publications in<br>JF & JFE |
| During JF editorship                   | -0.162<br>(0.2040)           |                             |                             |
| During JFE editorship                  |                              | -0.220<br>(0.3180)          |                             |
| During RFS editorship                  |                              |                             | -0.117<br>(0.1250)          |
| Journal fixed effects                  | Yes                          | Yes                         | Yes                         |
| School fixed effects                   | Yes                          | Yes                         | Yes                         |
| Year fixed effects                     | Yes                          | Yes                         | Yes                         |
| Observations                           | 2,108                        | 2,108                       | 1,632                       |
| Adjusted $R^2$                         | 0.3270                       | 0.4078                      | 0.3954                      |

(a) Table 8: other journals

which case its quality is  $Q > q_B$ . Alternatively, an  $E$  paper can be a “dud,” which is normalized to have zero quality. Denoting the probability of an  $E$  paper being path-breaking as  $p$ , the unconditional, expected quality of an  $E$  paper is  $Qp$ .

Second, although editors can easily tell  $E$  and  $B$  papers apart, distinguishing between good  $E$  papers (quality of  $Q$ ) and dud  $E$  papers (quality of zero) is hard. To capture this idea, suppose that upon receiving  $E$  paper  $i$ , an editor receives a binary signal (high or low),  $s_{E,i}$ , that is positively correlated with paper quality as follows:

$$s_{E,i}|(q_{E,i} = Q) = \begin{cases} \text{high w/prob. } x & x \geq \frac{1}{2} \\ \text{low w/prob. } 1-x & x < \frac{1}{2} \end{cases} \quad (5)$$

A symmetric case applies, i.e., if  $q_E = 0$ , a low signal will be received with probability  $x$ , and a high signal with probability  $1-x$ . The higher the value for  $x$ , the more informative is the editor's signal of an  $E$  paper's quality. There are two relevant regions for  $x$ :

*Case 1.*  $x < x^* = q_B(1-p)/(p(Q-q_B)+q_B(1-p))$ . If the editor's signal about  $E$  paper quality is sufficiently low, then even in the event that he receives a high signal, the posterior expectation of paper quality,  $(px/(px+(1-p)(1-x)))Q$ , is lower than the quality of a  $B$  paper,  $q_B$ .

*Case 2.*  $x \geq x^* = q_B(1-p)/p(Q-q_B)+q_B(1-p)$ . Here, the editor's signal is informative enough so that if he receives a high signal, his posterior quality assessment (at least) exceeds the quality of a  $B$  paper.

Assume now that editors make decisions taking into account only a paper's expected quality, given any signals received. Suppose further that an editor publishes  $T$  total papers per year, and that far more than this number of both  $E$  and  $B$  papers are submitted for publication. Finally, suppose that the members of an editor's network submit  $N$  “exciting” papers, and, both because it is probably realistic and to keep the expressions simple, assume that  $N < T$ . For the  $N$  number of connected exciting papers, [Case 2](#) applies, so that the editor can distinguish duds from home runs. For the remainder of exciting papers, [Case 1](#) applies.

Under these assumptions, it is easy to see how the model plays out both in a static and dynamic sense. In any given

(b) Model block: signals about exciting papers

## 6.9 Table 9: Robustness

**Read:** The main results survive alternative publication lags and alternative citation definitions.

**Economic message.** Results are not artifacts of one timing convention or citation measure.

**Table 9**

Robustness.

Panel A replicates the first column of Table 4 (Panel A) but changes the delay between editorship and publication. Column 1 assumes a one-year delay. Column 2 assumes a three-year delay. Column 3 follows the publication trends found in Ellison (2002a) and uses a one-year delay for all publications before 1970, a two-year delay for papers between 1970 and 1995, and a three-year delay for papers after 1995. Panel B replicates the final columns of Table 5 (Panel A) with a robust set of citation measures. The first three columns only consider citations received from journals on the list in Table 1. The final three columns winsorize the dependent variable (logged citations) at the 1% level. \*, \*\*, and \*\*\* represent significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

| Panel A: Publication counts                |                                  |           |                        |                      |                         |          |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|----------|
| Dependent variable: Published articles     |                                  |           |                        |                      |                         |          |
|                                            | 1-Year publication lag           |           | 3-Year publication lag |                      | Ellison publication lag |          |
| During editorship                          | 1.443***                         | (0.1540)  | 1.453***               | (0.163)              | 1.451***                | (0.162)  |
| Just before                                | 0.769***                         | (0.0750)  | 0.837***               | (0.079)              | 0.813***                | (0.077)  |
| Just after                                 | 0.824***                         | (0.1010)  | 0.760***               | (0.097)              | 0.774***                | (0.094)  |
| Observations                               | 163,520                          |           | 163,520                |                      | 163,520                 |          |
| Adjusted $R^2$                             | 0.0548                           |           | 0.0522                 |                      | 0.0523                  |          |
| p-Value for test: During=Before            | < 0.001                          |           | < 0.001                |                      | < 0.001                 |          |
| p-Value for test: During=After             | < 0.001                          |           | < 0.001                |                      | < 0.001                 |          |
| p-Value for test: Before=After             | 0.411                            |           | 0.269                  |                      | 0.564                   |          |
| Panel B: Citation counts                   |                                  |           |                        |                      |                         |          |
| Dependent variable: Log(times cited count) |                                  |           |                        |                      |                         |          |
|                                            | Only citations from top journals |           |                        | Winsorized citations |                         |          |
| Any-connected article                      | 0.250***                         | 0.055***  | 0.098***               | 0.240***             | 0.041**                 | 0.069*   |
|                                            | -0.016                           | -0.017    | -0.03                  | (0.020)              | (0.021)                 | (0.036)  |
| Times cited count: Last 5 years            | 0.105***                         | 0.089***  | 0.027***               | 0.113***             | 0.096***                | 0.041*** |
|                                            | -0.003                           | -0.003    | -0.01                  | (0.003)              | (0.003)                 | (0.011)  |
| Number of authors                          | -0.120***                        | -0.099*** | 0.013                  | -0.044***            | -0.027***               | 0.043**  |
|                                            | -0.008                           | -0.008    | -0.017                 | (0.009)              | (0.009)                 | (0.021)  |
| Journals*Year fixed effects                | Yes                              | Yes       | Yes                    | Yes                  | Yes                     | Yes      |
| School fixed effects                       | No                               | Yes       | No                     | No                   | Yes                     | No       |
| Author fixed effects                       | No                               | No        | Yes                    | No                   | No                      | Yes      |
| Observations                               | 54,046                           | 49,218    | 8,908                  | 54,046               | 49,218                  | 8,908    |
| Adjusted $R^2$                             | 0.3439                           | 0.3755    | 0.5328                 | 0.3955               | 0.4178                  | 0.6312   |

Table 9: robustness

## 7 Short summary

- Editor rotations sharply increase publication output for current colleagues.
- Placebo timing tests show the effect occurs during actual editorships.
- Connected papers receive more citations, not fewer.
- The citation premium survives excluding self- and same-journal citations.
- Competing-journal tests reject broad productivity spillovers.
- The model shows how networks can improve selection by providing editors with better signals about high-upside papers.

## 8 Conclusion

### 8.1 Core conclusion

Networks in academic publishing raise connected authors' publication output, but the additional papers appear to be higher quality on average. The evidence therefore favors informed selection over simple nepotism.

### 8.2 Incremental contribution revisited

The paper's contribution is to evaluate whether network advantages are allocatively efficient. It shows that connected decision-makers can improve selection when they possess superior information.

### **8.3 Mechanism**

The strongest evidence points to editor information rather than productivity spillovers: output increases only in the editor's own journal, not in close substitutes, and connected papers earn more citations.

### **8.4 Limitations**

The paper observes publications and citations, not submissions, referee reports, or editorial deliberations. Thus it cannot perfectly separate selection from beneficial editorial help.

### **8.5 Takeaway**

Networks are not necessarily inefficient. Their welfare effect depends on whether they transmit information or merely redistribute opportunities. In this setting, the information role appears important.